

BASED ON THE COMPETENCY BASED CURRICULUM — KENYA INSTITUTE OF CURRICULUM DEVELOPMENT

PHYSICAL EDUCATION

Learner's Book

GRADE 10

Ball Games • Athletics • Optional Sports

Prepared for Learners Aged 14–16

Preface: How to Use This Book

Welcome to Physical Education for Grade 10! This subject helps you build strong, skilful and healthy bodies while learning teamwork, discipline, safety and respect for others. This book covers three strands: **Ball Games**, **Athletics**, and **Optional Sports**. Each topic combines practical skill instruction with theory you need to understand technique, safety and the value of sport in your life.

Throughout each chapter you will meet the following special boxes:

	Coach's Idea Box	A key technical tip, safety reminder or coaching cue to remember.
	Reflection	A question to help you think deeply and connect the skill to your own life and community.
	Case Study	A real-life or realistic sporting scenario for you to analyse and discuss.
	Worksheet / Exercise	Practical and written tasks to build and check your mastery of each skill.
	End of Topic Questions	A final check of your understanding at the end of every chapter.

Always try each activity safely, under the guidance of your teacher, and wear appropriate sportswear. Model answers and marking guidance for the written questions are found in the **Answer Key** chapter at the end of the book — attempt every question yourself before checking there!

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✓	Answer Key

Ball Games

Ball games build coordination, teamwork, decision-making and fitness. In this chapter you will learn key skills in six popular ball games: Football, Netball, Volleyball, Handball, Basketball and Rugby. For each game, focus on correct technique, safety, and enjoying the game with your teammates.

SUB STRAND 1.1

Football

Facility & Equipment: a marked pitch, footballs, goal posts, nets, cones, bibs and a whistle. **Key Skills:** lofted pass, marking, dodging and goalkeeping.

Skill	Key Technical Points
Lofted Pass	Correct stance, clean ball contact under the ball, full follow through to lift the ball
Marking	Good positioning, anticipation, and concentration on the opponent and the ball
Dodging	Feinting, faking, quick turning and changing speed to beat an opponent
Goalkeeping	Quick reaction, diving, correct positioning, safe catching and punching technique

COACH'S IDEA BOX

When executing a lofted pass, strike the lower half of the ball with the instep and lean back slightly on follow-through — this gives the ball height without losing accuracy.

WORKSHEET 1.1: FOOTBALL

1. In pairs, practise the lofted pass 10 times each, then record how many passes landed accurately near your partner.
2. List three facilities/equipment used in football and describe one way to improvise each if it is unavailable.
3. Explain, in your own words, the difference between marking and dodging.
4. Play a mini football match in groups of 6, applying lofted passing, marking, dodging and goalkeeping while observing the rules.

REFLECTION

Why is marking and dodging essential when playing football? Think of a time you had to "read" an opponent's next move — how did you decide what to do?

SUB STRAND 1.2

Netball

Facility & Equipment: netball court, balls, goal posts, bibs, arm bands. **Key Skills:** flip pass and side pass.

Skill	Key Technical Points
Flip Pass	Correct stance and grip, quick wrist release, full follow through
Side Pass	Good stance, correct timing, accurate release toward the receiver

WORKSHEET 1.2: NETBALL

1. With a partner, take turns practising the flip pass and side pass, focusing on stance and follow through.
2. Suggest two ways netball equipment can be improvised in a school with limited resources.
3. Play a mini netball game in groups, applying flip pass and side pass while observing basic rules.

SUB STRAND 1.3

Volleyball

Facility & Equipment: a net, posts, open court/space, volleyballs. **Key Skill:** setting.

Skill	Key Technical Points
Setting	Correct stance, finger and arm placement above the forehead, soft release, full follow through
Variations	High set, back set and quick set for different attacking situations

COACH'S IDEA BOX

Form a "window" with your fingers and thumbs above your forehead before the ball arrives — this gives you a soft, controlled contact when setting.

WORKSHEET 1.3: VOLLEYBALL

- 1. Practise setting the ball to yourself 15 times, then to a partner 15 times. Record your success rate.
- 2. Explain how setting contributes to offensive play in volleyball.
- 3. Play a mini volleyball game applying high, back and quick sets while observing safety rules.

SUB STRAND 1.4
Handball

Facility & Equipment: handball court, goals, balls, whistle. **Key Skills:** sidestep and goalkeeping.

Skill	Key Technical Points
Sidestep	Correct stance, quick footwork, controlled speed, full follow through
Goalkeeping	Ready stance, quick lateral movement, effective shot blocking

WORKSHEET 1.4: HANDBALL

- 1. Take turns demonstrating the sidestep technique with peers, focusing on footwork and speed.
- 2. In groups, take turns practising goalkeeping (stance, movement, blocking) against soft shots.
- 3. Play a mini handball game applying sidestep and goalkeeping skills while observing safety.

CASE STUDY: KENYA'S HANDBALL GROWTH

Handball is a growing sport in Kenyan schools, with national school championships giving talented players a pathway to county and national teams. A student who mastered goalkeeping in Grade 10 went on to represent their county team within two years of consistent practice.

- 1. What does this case study suggest about the value of mastering basic skills early?
- 2. How can your school create more opportunities for learners to develop handball skills?

SUB STRAND 1.5
Basketball

Facility & Equipment: basketball court, hoops/rings, balls, cones. **Key Skills:** set shot, layup shot and jump shot.

Skill	Key Technical Points
Set Shot	Balanced stance, correct grip, smooth release, full follow through
Layup Shot	Controlled approach, correct stepping pattern, soft release off the backboard
Jump Shot	Balanced stance, correct grip, release at the peak of the jump, follow through

WORKSHEET 1.5: BASKETBALL

- 1. Practise 10 set shots, 10 layups and 10 jump shots. Record your success rate for each.
- 2. Explain how shot selection can affect a player's performance in a game.
- 3. Play a mini basketball game applying all three shooting techniques while observing safety.

REFLECTION

How can a player improve their shooting efficiency over time? Think about practice routines used by athletes you admire.

SUB STRAND 1.6
Rugby

Facility & Equipment: rugby pitch with marked playing zones, rugby balls, tackle bags. **Key Skills:** dodging & marking, and the grubber kick.

Skill	Key Technical Points
Dodging & Marking	Good balance, speed variation, quick change of direction

CASE STUDY: RUGBY ON THE WORLD STAGE

The Kenya Sevens rugby team, "Shujaa," has represented Kenya in international tournaments including the World Rugby Sevens Series, raising Kenya's profile in world sport. Many of these players began learning basic dodging, marking and kicking skills in school.

1. How has rugby improved Kenya's visibility on the global stage?
2. How can values learnt in school rugby (teamwork, discipline, respect) be useful beyond sport?

WORKSHEET 1.6: RUGBY

1. Practise dodging and marking with a partner while observing safety rules.
2. Practise the grubber kick, focusing on body position, contact and follow through.
3. Play a mini rugby game (touch or tag rugby) applying the skills learnt while observing safety.

END OF CHAPTER 1 QUESTIONS

1. List the equipment needed to play football, netball and basketball.
2. Describe the correct technique for a lofted pass in football.
3. Explain the difference between the flip pass and side pass in netball.
4. Why is correct hand and finger placement important when setting in volleyball?
5. Describe the stance, movement and blocking technique used in handball goalkeeping.
6. Compare the set shot, layup shot and jump shot in basketball.
7. Explain the technical points to consider when performing a grubber kick in rugby.
8. Choose any two ball games from this chapter and explain how playing them can promote good health.

Athletics

Athletics is the foundation of many sports, building speed, strength, power and coordination. Kenya is world-renowned for athletics excellence. In this chapter you will learn sprinting, long jump, javelin throw and shot put techniques.

SUB STRAND 2.1
Sprints

Key Skills: starts (bunch, medium, elongated), acceleration and the dip finish.

Phase	Key Technical Points
Bunch Start	Feet close together at the blocks for a fast initial drive
Medium Start	Feet at moderate spacing, balancing power and control
Elongated Start	Feet spaced further apart for greater initial stability
Acceleration	Forward body lean, powerful leg drive, coordinated arm action
Dip Finish	Forward lean of the torso and chest at the finish line, correct arm action

COACH'S IDEA BOX

Keep your head down and eyes on the track during the first few strides out of the blocks — lifting your head too early reduces your acceleration power.

- WORKSHEET 2.1: SPRINTS**
1. Practise the bunch, medium and elongated starts, then note which felt most comfortable and why.
 2. In pairs, time each other over a 60m sprint, recording body position during acceleration.
 3. Demonstrate the dip finish technique with a partner observing your form.

REFLECTION

Why is participating in sprinting events beneficial to young people in Kenya, beyond competition and fitness?

SUB STRAND 2.2
Long Jump

Facility & Equipment: runway, take-off board, sand pit, rake, tape measure. **Phases:** approach, take-off, flight (hang or hitch-kick), landing and recovery.

Phase	Key Technical Points
Approach	Consistent, accelerating run-up to the take-off board
Take-off	Powerful upward drive from one foot at the board
Flight	Hang technique (body extended) or hitch-kick (leg cycling) to maintain balance
Landing/Recovery	Legs extended forward, controlled fall forward to avoid losing distance

- WORKSHEET 2.2: LONG JUMP**
1. Practise the hang and hitch-kick techniques, following all four phases, using a marked runway.
 2. Measure and record the distance of three of your jumps.
 3. Explain, in your own words, why safety is important when performing long jump.

SUB STRAND 2.3
Javelin Throw

Phases: grip, carriage, approach, crossover, release and follow through.

Phase	Key Technical Points
Grip & Carriage	Firm grip on the cord, javelin carried above the shoulder

Approach	Building controlled speed toward the throwing line
Crossover	Quick crossing steps to transfer momentum into the throw
Release & Follow Through	Explosive arm action at release, body follows the throw to maintain balance

CASE STUDY: JULIUS YEGO, "JAVELIN JD"

Julius Yego, a Kenyan javelin thrower, largely trained by watching online videos, became the 2015 World Champion and won an Olympic silver medal in 2016 — proving that dedication and self-directed learning of correct technique can lead to international success.

1. What lesson does Yego's story teach about using digital resources to learn sports skills?
2. How can you apply similar dedication to mastering a skill in this chapter?

WORKSHEET 2.3: JAVELIN THROW

1. Practise the grip and carriage positions with a partner checking your form.
2. Under teacher supervision, practise the full javelin throw sequence while observing strict safety rules.
3. List three safety rules that must always be followed during javelin practice.

SUB STRAND 2.4

Shot Put

Styles: O'Brien style (grip, stance, glide, swing, release, recovery) and Spin style (grip, stance, rotation, release, recovery).

Style	Key Technical Points
O'Brien Style	Backward-facing glide across the circle before releasing the shot
Spin Style	Rotational movement (like a discus turn) to generate power before release

WORKSHEET 2.4: SHOT PUT

1. Practise the O'Brien style, focusing on grip, stance, glide, release and recovery.
2. Practise the Spin style with a partner checking your rotation and release.
3. Why is training consistently important for improving shot put performance?

END OF CHAPTER 2 QUESTIONS

1. Name and describe the three types of sprint starts.
2. Explain why body alignment is important during the acceleration phase of a sprint.
3. List the four phases of the long jump in the correct order.
4. Describe the six phases of the javelin throw.
5. Compare the O'Brien and Spin styles of shot put.
6. Explain two ways safety can be enhanced when practising athletics events.
7. How has athletics contributed to Kenya's reputation internationally?

Optional Sports

Your school will choose at least two of the sports in this chapter, depending on available facilities and equipment. Each optional sport builds unique skills, and all of them promote fitness, teamwork and enjoyment. Learn the sport(s) chosen by your school well, and read about the others to broaden your sporting knowledge.

SUB STRAND 3.1

Hockey

Key Skills: dribbling, passing, hitting and stopping.

Skill	Key Technical Points
Dribbling	Single and double dribble, keeping the ball close with soft stick control
Passing	Push, drive and sweep passes for different distances and speeds
Hitting/Stopping	Flat stick and reverse stick techniques for control

WORKSHEET 3.1: HOCKEY

1. Practise single and double dribbling around cones.
2. Practise push, drive and sweep passes with a partner.
3. Play a mini hockey game combining dribbling, passing, hitting and stopping while observing safety.

REFLECTION

Why is teamwork especially important in hockey compared to individual sports?

SUB STRAND 3.2

Swimming

Key Skills: front crawl, backstroke (body position, leg, arm and breathing action) and turns (open and tumble).

Stroke	Key Technical Points
Front Crawl	Flat body position, alternating arm pull, flutter kick, rhythmic breathing to the side
Backstroke	Body on back, alternating arm pull, continuous flutter kick, controlled breathing
Turns	Open turn (touch and push off) and tumble turn (somersault push off) at the wall

COACH'S IDEA BOX

Always swim with a qualified instructor or lifeguard present, and never swim alone — water safety comes before skill practice.

WORKSHEET 3.2: SWIMMING

1. Practise front crawl and backstroke arm and leg actions at the pool edge before swimming full lengths.
2. Practise the open turn and, if confident, the tumble turn under supervision.
3. Explain how backstroke skills could be useful in a life-saving situation.

SUB STRAND 3.3

Softball

Key Skills: batting (grip, stance, swing, follow through) and pitching (stance, grip, swing, release, follow through).

WORKSHEET 3.3: SOFTBALL

1. Practise batting technique against a soft toss from a partner.
2. Practise pitching technique, focusing on stance, grip and release.
3. Play a mini softball game applying batting and pitching skills while observing safety.

SUB STRAND 3.4

Baseball5

Key Skill: hitting (stance, toss, swing, contact, follow through).

WORKSHEET 3.4: BASEBALL5

1. Practise the hitting technique, focusing on stance, toss and contact.
2. Play a mini Baseball5 game applying the hitting skill while observing safety.
3. How can the skills learnt in Baseball5 be applied in community recreation?

SUB STRAND 3.5

Cricket

Key Skill: batting — cover drive, hook shot and lofted shot (stance, footwork, contact, follow through).

CASE STUDY: GROWTH OF CRICKET IN KENYA

Kenya's national cricket team once reached the semi-finals of the 2003 Cricket World Cup, inspiring many schools to introduce cricket. Learners who master basic batting shots early often go on to represent county and national youth teams.

1. What can other sports learn from cricket's approach to skill development in schools?
2. How does playing cricket promote individual development?

WORKSHEET 3.5: CRICKET

1. Practise the cover drive, hook shot and lofted shot with a partner bowling underarm.
2. Play a conditioned game of cricket applying the batting skills learnt while observing safety.

SUB STRAND 3.6

Table Tennis

Key Skills: forehand drive, backhand drive and push shot (grip, stance, contact, follow through).

WORKSHEET 3.6: TABLE TENNIS

1. Practise forehand and backhand drives against a partner or wall.
2. Practise the push shot, focusing on grip and contact.
3. Suggest how a table tennis table and bat can be improvised using locally available materials.

SUB STRAND 3.7

Tennis

Key Skills: forehand drive and backhand drive (grip, stance, contact, follow through).

WORKSHEET 3.7: TENNIS

1. Practise forehand and backhand drives with a partner or against a wall.
2. Apply forehand and backhand drives in a mini tennis game.
3. How has tennis put Kenya on the world map?

SUB STRAND 3.8

Badminton

Key Skills: forehand clear, backhand clear, forehand drop shot and backhand drop shot (grip, stance, swing, follow through).

COACH'S IDEA BOX

A relaxed grip on the racquet gives you better wrist control for both powerful clears and delicate drop shots.

WORKSHEET 3.8: BADMINTON

1. Practise forehand and backhand clears with a partner.
2. Practise forehand and backhand drop shots, focusing on disguising your shot.
3. Play a mini badminton game applying clears and drop shots.

REFLECTION

How does the grip used in racquet sports (table tennis, tennis, badminton) affect the accuracy and power of your shots?

END OF CHAPTER 3 QUESTIONS

1. List the two optional sports offered at your school and describe one key skill for each.
2. Describe the correct technique for front crawl breathing in swimming.
3. Compare batting in softball, Baseball5 and cricket in terms of stance and swing.
4. Explain the difference between a forehand drive and a push shot in table tennis.
5. Describe the technical points of a badminton drop shot.
6. Why must schools prioritise safety and supervision, especially in swimming and cricket?
7. Choose one optional sport and explain how playing it can enhance mental health.

Answer Key

Use this chapter **after** attempting the worksheets and end of chapter questions yourself. Practical skills should be assessed by your teacher using the rubrics your teacher has for each sport (based on correct technique, consistency and safety). Written answers below are model answers — your own wording may differ but should cover the same key ideas.

Chapter 1: Ball Games

Worksheet Answers (selected)

1.1 Football: Marking = staying close to and anticipating an opponent's movement to prevent them receiving/using the ball; Dodging = using feints, faking and speed changes to get past an opponent while in possession. **1.2 Netball:** Flip pass uses a quick wrist-driven release; side pass uses a wider swinging motion timed for a moving receiver. **1.5 Basketball:** A set shot is taken from a stationary position; a layup is taken while moving toward the basket; a jump shot is released at the peak of a vertical jump — shot choice depends on defender position and distance from the basket.

End of Chapter 1 Questions

1. Football: ball, pitch, goal posts, nets, cones/markers. Netball: ball, court, goal posts, bibs. Basketball: ball, court, hoop/ring.
2. Correct stance behind the ball, strike the lower half of the ball with the instep, follow through upward to loft the ball to a teammate.
3. Flip pass: short, quick, wrist-driven pass for close-range use. Side pass: wider, timed pass used to beat a defender or cover more distance.
4. Correct hand/finger placement (forming a "window" above the forehead) ensures a soft, controlled, accurate contact with the ball.
5. Stance: balanced, ready position; Movement: quick lateral steps to cover the goal; Blocking: hands/body positioned to stop the ball.
6. Set shot (stationary, high accuracy), layup (close range while moving), jump shot (mid/long range, harder to block due to jump height).
7. Correct body position over the ball, controlled contact with the foot, low release to keep the ball along the ground, full follow through.
8. Any two: e.g. Football and basketball both build cardiovascular fitness, coordination and teamwork, reducing risk of lifestyle diseases.

Chapter 2: Athletics

Worksheet Answers (selected)

2.1: Bunch start = feet close together (fastest drive, less stable); medium = moderate spacing; elongated = feet far apart (more stable, slightly slower drive). **2.3:** Safety rules for javelin: throw only when the sector is clear, throw only on a signal from the teacher, never walk to retrieve javelins while others are throwing.

End of Chapter 2 Questions

1. Bunch (feet close together), medium (moderate spacing) and elongated (feet far apart) starts.
2. Correct body alignment channels power efficiently into forward motion and reduces injury risk during acceleration.
3. Approach → Take-off → Flight (hang/hitch-kick) → Landing and Recovery.
4. Grip → Carriage → Approach → Crossover → Release → Follow Through.
5. O'Brien style uses a backward glide across the circle; Spin style uses a rotational movement for more power but requires more balance and skill.
6. Any two: e.g. clearing the throwing/landing sector before starting, using correct starting blocks, following the teacher's signal to begin.
7. Kenyan athletes have won numerous world and Olympic medals in distance running and field events, making Kenya globally recognised in athletics.

Chapter 3: Optional Sports

Worksheet Answers (selected)

3.1 Hockey: Push, drive and sweep passes differ in force and distance — push for short accurate passes, drive for long powerful passes, sweep for wide low passes. **3.6 Table Tennis:** A table can be improvised using a flat wooden surface with a raised net-line (e.g. string and books); bats can be improvised with flat wooden paddles.

End of Chapter 3 Questions

1. Answers will vary depending on the two sports offered at the learner's school.
2. Turn the head to the side in rhythm with the arm stroke, breathing out underwater and in above the surface.
3. All three use a stance-swing-contact-follow through pattern, but bat/grip size, ball type and swing plane differ between the three sports.
4. A drive is a fast, attacking stroke that keeps the ball low and quick; a push shot is a controlled, defensive stroke that keeps the ball short and low over the net.
5. Correct grip and stance, a disguised backswing (similar to the clear), and a soft, controlled release just over the net.
6. Swimming carries drowning risk without supervision; cricket's hard ball can cause injury without protective gear — both need trained

supervision and safety equipment.

7. Any sport: participation reduces stress, builds self-esteem through skill mastery, and provides constructive use of leisure time.

FOR TEACHERS AND LEARNERS

For practical skills, use the Suggested Assessment Rubrics from the curriculum (Exceeds / Meets / Approaches / Below Expectations) based on correct execution of each technical aspect of a skill, consistency of performance, and observance of safety rules.